Dermatology Service Line Handbook

MERIDIAN HEALTH PARTNERS
OPERATIONS POLICY MANUAL
SECTION 4: SERVICE LINE HANDBOOK – DERMATOLOGY
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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

1.1 This service line handbook establishes operational standards, scheduling parameters, clinical inclusion criteria, and insurance billing workflows for the Dermatology department across all fourteen Meridian Health Partners facilities.

1.2 Compliance with this document is mandatory for all administrative staff, scheduling coordinators, and clinical personnel within the Dermatology department.

2. ACCEPTED AND EXPLICITLY NOT ACCEPTED CONDITIONS

2.1 The Dermatology department accepts referrals for the evaluation, diagnosis, and surgical management of primary cutaneous conditions, including but not limited to inflammatory dermatoses, neoplastic skin lesions, acneiform disorders, and chronic pruritus.

2.2 The department explicitly does not accept referrals for cosmetic-only procedures (including non-therapeutic chemical peels, laser hair removal, and elective dermal filler injections), severe systemic autoimmune blistering diseases requiring inpatient biologic induction, or Mohs micrographic surgery (which must be routed to the Surgical Oncology service line).

3. ACCESS TO CARE AND TIMELINES

3.1 The Department of Dermatology commits to offering a first appointment to any patient with an accepted referral within 14 calendar days of initial referral receipt.

3.2 Referral intake, triage, and processing turnaround times are governed exclusively by the Referral Management Policy (MHP-POL-REF-01); staff shall not apply independent turnaround thresholds within this department.

4. APPOINTMENT DURATION AND SERVICE CATALOGUE

4.1 All specialty services within Dermatology shall run between 20 and 45 minutes, as detailed in the service catalogue below.

4.2 DERM-CONS: Dermatology Consultation
* Description: Initial clinical consultation and skin examination.
* List Price: $160.00
* Duration: 20 minutes.

4.3 DERM-BIOP: Skin Biopsy Pathology
* Description: Diagnostic skin tissue procurement and laboratory pathology analysis.
* List Price: $380.00
* Duration: 20 minutes.

4.4 DERM-EXCI: Lesion Excision
* Description: Surgical removal of suspicious or confirmed neoplastic skin lesions.
* List Price: $1,150.00
* Duration: 45 minutes.

5. PATIENT PREPARATION INSTRUCTIONS

5.1 Scheduling coordinators shall provide patients with the following mandatory preparation instructions at the time of booking:
* Patients must arrive at the clinic 15 minutes prior to their scheduled appointment time for administrative check-in.
* Patients shall attend the appointment with unmasked, makeup-free skin on the area scheduled for examination.
* Patients must bring a complete, written list of all current topical and systemic medications.

6. INSURANCE COVERAGE AND PRE-AUTHORISATION MATRIX

6.1 Coverage tiers and pre-authorisation timelines for each Meridian health plan are structured strictly according to the following matrix:

* DERM-CONS (Dermatology Consultation, 20 mins, List Price $160):
* MERIDIAN-GOLD: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.
* MERIDIAN-SILVER: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.
* MERIDIAN-BRONZE: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.
* CIVIC-BASE: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.

* DERM-BIOP (Skin Biopsy Pathology, 20 mins, List Price $380):
* MERIDIAN-GOLD: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.
* MERIDIAN-SILVER: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.
* MERIDIAN-BRONZE: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.
* CIVIC-BASE: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.

* DERM-EXCI (Lesion Excision, 45 mins, List Price $1,150):
* MERIDIAN-GOLD: Covered; pre-authorisation required within 2 business days.
* MERIDIAN-SILVER: Covered; pre-authorisation required within 3 business days.
* MERIDIAN-BRONZE: Covered; pre-authorisation required within 5 business days.
* CIVIC-BASE: Covered; pre-authorisation required within 7 business days.

6.2 No administrative or clinical staff member possesses the authority to waive pre-authorisation requirements or alter coverage tiers defined in Section 6.1 without the written consent of Marcus Chen, Director of Revenue Cycle Operations.

END OF POLICY MHP-SLH-DERM-04